

Helicopter

A helicopter's long, thin rotor blades have a curved shape, similar to that of an aircraft's wing. When these blades are spun quickly by the engine, they travel through the air and, like an aircraft wing, create lift. Their ability to take off and land vertically, and to hover midair, make helicopters incredibly useful for military and police work, and search-and-rescue missions, as performed by this **Sea King**.



Westland Sea King HAR.3

Rotor head

Radar dome

Foldable hinged
tail boom

Winch crane

Tail rotor
blade

Tailplane

Tail rotor › This six-bladed rotor spins to balance out the effects of the main rotor blades. By varying the speeds of the tail rotor, the pilot can use it as a rudder to steer.

Sponson › This contains inflatable bags, which can be filled with air to help the helicopter float, should it land on water.